

Case 12: Launch It or Shelve It?

Go/No-Go Decision

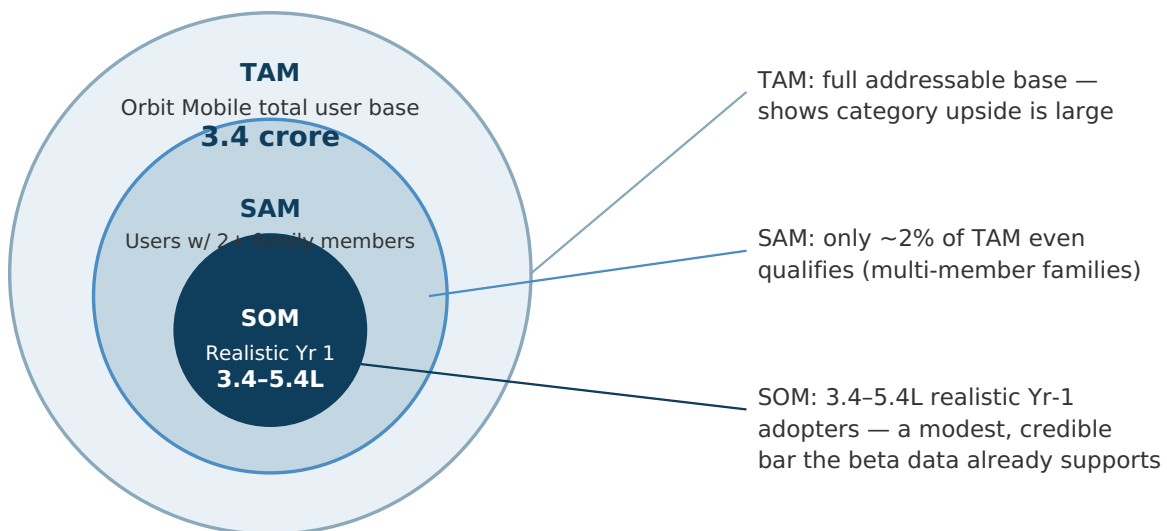
Framework: TAM-SAM-SOM + Launch Readiness

RECOMMENDED DECISION

Delay two weeks — do not launch Monday as planned, do not shelve.

The market opportunity is real and the product is technically sound, but two of the four readiness pillars (Marketing, Legal) are not ready and the low repeat-usage signal points to a fixable communication gap, not a fundamental demand problem. A short, focused delay protects the launch's first impression without giving up the competitive window.

Framework 1: TAM-SAM-SOM — Is the Opportunity Worth Protecting?



Framework 2: Launch Readiness Snapshot

PRODUCT / TECH



No major bugs
in last 2 weeks

READY

CUSTOMER FEEDBACK



4.3/5 rating, but only
22% used it twice+

MIXED

MARKETING



Explainer video
only 40% ready

NOT READY

LEGAL / BILLING



Shared billing/tax
review incomplete

NOT READY

2 of 4 pillars ready or strong, 1 mixed, 2 not ready → signal points to **delay**, not launch or shelve.

Discussion Question Responses

1. Should Orbit Mobile launch on Monday as planned, delay two weeks, or shelve the feature?

Delay two weeks. TAM-SAM-SOM confirms the opportunity is worth pursuing — a realistic 3.4-5.4 lakh Year-1 adopters is a credible, sizable win, and beta data (4.3/5 rating, no competitor equivalent) supports genuine demand, so shelving would forfeit a validated opportunity and hand the competitive window to a rival with no equivalent feature. But launching Monday as-is means going live with only 40% of marketing materials ready and legal sign-off incomplete in some states — both are the kind of gaps that damage first impressions and invite support and compliance headaches that are far more expensive to fix after launch than before it. Two weeks is enough to close both gaps without losing the competitive lead, since the competitor still lacks the feature.

2. Is the low repeat-usage number in beta testing a big enough concern to stop the launch?

No — it's a real concern, but not a stop-the-launch concern. The 22% repeat-usage rate sits alongside two explanatory signals in the same data: customer support flagged confusion about how billing splits between family members, and the explainer video meant to clarify exactly that is only 40% complete. This points to a usability/communication problem rather than a lack of interest — people tried the feature, liked it enough to rate it 4.3/5, but didn't understand it well enough to return. That is precisely the kind of issue a finished explainer video and clearer billing UX can fix, which is another reason a short delay is the right call rather than shelving on the basis of this metric alone.

3. If you were the product lead, what would you tell leadership by end of day?

Recommend a two-week delay with a specific punch list: finish the explainer video, resolve the billing-split confusion in the UI and support scripts, and get legal clarity in the states still under review (or explicitly exclude those states from a phased launch if timing doesn't allow full clearance). Frame it as protecting a validated opportunity — sizable, competitor-free market, strong beta ratings, clean technical testing — from an avoidable weak first impression, rather than as a loss of momentum. The two-week cost is low because the competitor still has no equivalent offering.

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- TAM-SAM-SOM validates whether an opportunity is worth protecting; Launch Readiness determines whether now is the right moment to capture it.
- A single soft metric (like repeat usage) should be diagnosed against other data before it's treated as a go/no-go signal on its own.
- "Delay" is not indecision — it's the correct call when the product is ready but the supporting functions (marketing, legal) are not.